de regimineprincipum (on the Rule of Sovereigns) while he was at the papal court in Italy (1259-68). Following ***Aristotle*** he held that the state is a natural and not a conventional institution and it is a perfect society (communities perfecta). He argued that it is n atural and not conventional because human beings were social animals. They needed to form a society to survive, prosper and for their cultural development. Gregarious animals do this by instinct but humans on the other hand do it by reason.

All power according to Aquinas comes from God since it involves the power of life and death which in the Church's doctrine is a prerogative of God. It is at this juncture that Aquinas deviates from ***Aristotle*** but returns when he turns to the question of the sovereign which is natural. It is natural in that without a governing body capable of making decisions that would be binding, it would result in anarchy and people would destroy each other. The sovereign or government in the view of Aquinas is the representative of those governed.

The state therefore, is not in any way dependent on the church. Aquinas argued that each had a separate role and an end. However, in Aquinas' view the Church is not subordinate to the state, whereas the state on the other hand must take into consideration of the Church since its end is higher than that of the state and is the ultimate end of the citizen. Aquinas likens the relationship of the church to the state to that of the soul and the body. Each has a separate role to play but ultimately the soul's purpose is loftier.

7.4 Niccolo Machiavelli (1469-1527)



Learning Objectives

1. To understand the Political thought of ***Niccolo Machiavelli***
2. This will help to compare thinkers on similar concept.
3. To know about ***Niccolo Machiavelli*** Politics and Religion, State, Advice to the Prince.

Life and Times

Machiavelli was born in Florence, the centre of Italian culture where influence of Italian culture where influence of the European Renaissance was the strongest among all areas as the third child of attorney Bernardo di ***Niccolo Machiavelli*** and his wife Bartolomea di Stefano Nelli. His writings reveal that he received an excellent humanist education that was informed by the Renaissance values. He entered the service of the Republican Government in 1494, the tear of expulsion of the Medici. From 1498 to 1512 he was Secretary to the Chancellery an important post which was concerned with diplomatic, military and administrative affairs. In 1512, consequent upon the restoration of the Medici, ***Machiavelli*** lost his office

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